NEBIUS - HR SCREENING INTERVIEW PREP

Date: February 11, 2026 | 1:00 PM CET | Interviewer: Milly C. Muschitiello
Role: Data Engineer | Location: Amsterdam (Hybrid)

INTERVIEW DETAILS

Company	Nebius Group N.V. (NASDAQ: NBIS)
Role	Data Engineer - Amsterdam, Netherlands (Hybrid)
Interviewer	Milly C. Muschitiello (HR / Recruiter)
Date & Time	Feb 11, 2026 at 1:00 PM CET
Platform	Zoom
Interview Type	HR Screening (first round, ~30 min)

PRE-CALL CHECKLIST

- Test Zoom link 15 min early. Have backup: phone dial-in.
- Quiet room, good lighting, clean background.
- Have this cheat sheet open on a second screen or printed.
- Water bottle nearby. Notepad and pen ready.
- Phone on silent. Close all notifications.

PART 1: SELF INTRODUCTION

自我介绍背诵稿 - 控制在60-90秒，语速放慢，每句话之间停顿

MEMORIZE THIS - "TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF"

Hi Milly, thank you for taking the time to speak with me today.

My name is Fei Huang. I am a **data engineer** based in Amsterdam. I have about **six years** of experience working with data, across **fintech, quantitative finance, and e-commerce**.

Most recently, I completed my **Master's in Artificial Intelligence** at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, with a GPA of 8.2 out of 10. I also hold a **Databricks Certified Data Engineer Professional** certification.

On the technical side, I work mainly with **Python, SQL, PySpark, Airflow, and Delta Lake**. Right now I am building a **financial data lakehouse** project using Spark, Delta Lake, and Medallion Architecture.

I am very excited about Nebius because you are building **AI infrastructure at an incredible scale**. The Data Engineer role is a great match for my skills, and I would love to contribute to your data platform.

SPEAKING TIPS FOR THIS SECTION

- **Pace:** Read each paragraph, then PAUSE. Do not rush.
- **Emphasis:** Bold words = slightly louder and slower.
- **Smile:** Smile when you say "excited" and "great match".
- **Practice:** Time yourself. Should be 60-90 seconds.

PART 2: COMMON HR QUESTIONS & PREPARED ANSWERS

HR常见问题 - 红色=问题（对方可能说的话），绿色=你的回答

Q1: "Why are you interested in Nebius?"

你为什么对Nebius感兴趣?

YOUR ANSWER

Three reasons.

First, Nebius is building AI infrastructure at a massive scale. Your partnerships with NVIDIA, Microsoft, and Meta show that you are at the center of the AI revolution. I want to be part of that.

Second, I really admire the company's journey. Going from Yandex to Nebius, rebuilding as a global company with startup energy but enterprise resources — that takes real vision and courage.

Third, Amsterdam is the real headquarters, not a satellite office. I live here, and I want to work at a company where the important decisions happen around me.

Q2: "Walk me through your experience" / "Tell me about your background"

介绍一下你的经历/背景

YOUR ANSWER

Sure. I started my career in Shanghai as a **data analyst at Ele.me**, which is like the DoorDash of China. It was later acquired by Alibaba. There I worked with large-scale user data on Hadoop and Hive.

Then I moved to **Baiquan Investment** as a quantitative developer. I built market data pipelines and factor computation engines for quantitative trading.

After that, I joined **GLP Technology** as a data engineer and team lead. I built PySpark ETL pipelines, data quality frameworks, and compliance reporting systems for a fintech company.

In 2023, I moved to Amsterdam for my **Master's in AI** at Vrije Universiteit. I graduated in August 2025 with a GPA of 8.2. Since then, I have been working on personal projects and got my **Databricks certification**.

Q3: "Why Data Engineering? Why not Data Science or ML?"

为什么选数据工程而不是数据科学或机器学习?

YOUR ANSWER

Great question. I have experience in both areas, but I find that I enjoy **building reliable systems** the most.

Data engineering is where I can combine my software skills with my understanding of data and business needs. I like making sure that data flows correctly, is clean, and is ready for others to use.

My AI background actually helps me be a **better data engineer**, because I understand what data scientists and ML engineers need from the data platform.

Q4: "What do you know about Nebius?"

你对Nebius了解多少?

YOUR ANSWER

Nebius is an **AI infrastructure company** listed on NASDAQ. You provide a full-stack AI cloud platform built on large-scale NVIDIA GPU clusters.

The company was born from Yandex's international business after the restructuring in 2024. Your founder, Arkady Volozh, calls it "a startup with two and a half billion dollars."

You are growing very fast — **355 percent revenue growth** year over year in Q3 2025. You have major partnerships with Microsoft and Meta. And I know your Q4 earnings report comes out on February 12th — tomorrow, actually.

Your headquarters is here in Amsterdam, and you also have data centers in Finland, the US, and France.

Q5: "What is your current situation? Are you working now?"

你现在的状态是什么？在工作吗?

YOUR ANSWER

I graduated from my Master's program in August 2025. Since then, I have been **actively job searching** while working on personal projects to keep my skills sharp.

For example, I built a **financial data lakehouse** using Databricks, Spark, Delta Lake, and Airflow. I also got my **Databricks Data Engineer Professional** certification in October 2025.

So I am available to start **immediately**.

Q6: "What are your salary expectations?"

你的薪资期望是多少?

YOUR ANSWER (TRY TO DEFLECT FIRST)

I would love to learn more about the **full compensation package** first — base salary, equity, and benefits. Could you share the budgeted range for this role?

If they insist on a number:

Based on my research and experience level, I am looking at around **110 to 130 thousand euros** in total compensation. But I am flexible depending on the full package, especially equity and benefits.

SALARY CONTEXT (do not say these numbers out loud)

Glassdoor Reference	Range
Software Engineer (Nebius NL)	€86K - €108K
Data Analyst (Nebius NL)	€85K - €121K
Senior Software Developer (Nebius NL)	€105K - €140K
Senior Software Engineer (Nebius NL)	€136K - €173K

Remember: Nebius is NASDAQ-listed, so **RSU/equity** is part of the package. Ask about 30% ruling.

Q7: "Do you need visa sponsorship?" / "What is your work authorization?"

你需要签证担保吗？你的工作许可状态？

YOUR ANSWER (ADAPT TO YOUR ACTUAL SITUATION)

I currently have a **search year visa** (zoekjaar) which allows me to work in the Netherlands. For long-term employment, I would need a **highly skilled migrant visa** (kennismigrant), which I understand Nebius is a recognized sponsor for.

Q8: "When can you start?"

你什么时候可以入职？

YOUR ANSWER

I am available to start **immediately**. I can begin as soon as the visa process is completed.

Q9: "What is your biggest strength?"

你最大的优势是什么？

YOUR ANSWER

I would say my biggest strength is my **versatility**. I have worked across data analysis, quantitative development, data engineering, and machine learning.

This means I can **talk to different teams** and understand their needs. When I build a data pipeline, I think about who will use the data and how.

Q10: "What is your biggest weakness?"

你最大的弱点是什么？

YOUR ANSWER

I sometimes spend **too much time** trying to make things perfect before shipping. I have learned to balance this by setting clear deadlines for myself and focusing on **"good enough to ship, then iterate."**

Q11: "Why did you leave China?" / "Why Amsterdam?"

你为什么离开中国？为什么选阿姆斯特丹？

YOUR ANSWER

I wanted to **challenge myself internationally** and deepen my knowledge of AI. Amsterdam has a great tech ecosystem and a very international culture.

After completing my Master's here, I decided to **build my career in Europe**. I enjoy the work-life balance and the collaborative culture in Dutch companies.

Q12: "Tell me about a challenging project"

讲一个有挑战性的项目

YOUR ANSWER (STAR FORMAT)

Situation: At GLP Technology, we had data quality issues in our credit scoring pipeline. Bad data was causing wrong risk assessments.

Task: I was asked to build a data quality framework to catch problems before they reached the scoring models.

Action: I designed a validation framework using PySpark that checked data at every stage of the pipeline. It included schema validation, null checks, and business rule validation.

Result: We reduced data quality incidents by over 90 percent. The framework became the standard for all new pipelines in the team.

Q13: "How do you handle working in a team?" / "Describe your teamwork style"

你如何在团队中工作?

YOUR ANSWER

At GLP, I was a **team lead** managing a small team. I learned that good communication is the most important thing.

I like to have **clear documentation**, regular check-ins, and open discussions. I believe in giving people ownership of their work while being available to help when needed.

Q14: "Do you have experience with on-call rotations?"

你有on-call轮值经验吗? (JD里提到了这个)

YOUR ANSWER

Yes, at GLP I was part of the on-call rotation for our data pipelines. I am comfortable with monitoring, alerting, and responding to production issues. I understand that **data reliability is critical**, especially for a company like Nebius that serves enterprise customers.

Q15: "Where do you see yourself in 3-5 years?"

你3-5年后的规划?

YOUR ANSWER

In 3 to 5 years, I want to be a **senior data engineer** or a **tech lead** in data infrastructure.

Nebius is growing so fast that I think there will be many opportunities to take on more responsibility. I want to grow with the company and help build the data platform that powers your AI cloud.

Q16: "Do you have any questions for me?"

你有什么问题要问我吗? (一定要问!)

YOUR QUESTIONS (PICK 3-4)

1. **"How big is the data engineering team right now, and what projects are they working on?"**
   数据工程团队多大？在做什么项目？
2. **"What does the tech stack look like for data engineering at Nebius?"**
   数据工程的技术栈是什么？
3. **"What does the interview process look like after this call?"**
   后续面试流程是什么？
4. **"Nebius is growing very fast. How does the team handle that growth?"**
   公司增长这么快，团队怎么应对？
5. **"Is the 30% ruling applicable for this position?"**
   这个职位适用30% ruling吗？

PART 3: NEBIUS COMPANY KNOWLEDGE

公司知识速查 - 面试中随时可能用到的关键信息

COMPANY BASICS

Full Name	Nebius Group N.V.
Stock	NASDAQ: NBIS
HQ	Amsterdam, Netherlands
CEO	Arkady Volozh *(ar-KAH-dee VOH-lozh)*
Employees	2,000+
Founded	2024 (rebranded from Yandex N.V.)
What they do	Full-stack AI cloud platform on NVIDIA GPUs

KEY NUMBERS (memorize these)

Q3 2025 Revenue	$146.1 million (up 355% YoY)
9-month 2025 Revenue	$302.1 million (up 437% YoY)
Cash Position	$4.79 billion
Microsoft Deal	Multi-year, tens of billions of dollars
Meta Deal	~$3 billion over 5 years
Q4 Earnings	February 12, 2026 (day after your interview!)

HISTORY TIMELINE

Pre-2022	Yandex N.V. = "Google of Russia", $31B market cap
2022	Russia-Ukraine war → EU sanctions on Volozh
Feb 2024	Sold all Russian business for $5.4B
Mar 2024	Sanctions lifted, Volozh returns as CEO
Oct 2024	Rebranded to Nebius, relisted on NASDAQ
2025	Explosive growth: Microsoft, Meta, NVIDIA deals

PRODUCTS & BUSINESS UNITS

- **Nebius AI Cloud** — Core product. GPU clusters for AI training & inference.
- **Token Factory** — Production AI inference at scale.
- **AI Studio** — Inference-as-a-Service platform.
- **Tavily** — Recently acquired. Agentic search for AI agents.
- **Avride** — Autonomous vehicles (partnership with Uber).
- **TripleTen** — EdTech for tech career reskilling.

DATA CENTERS

Mantsala, Finland	Flagship. PUE 1.13. Heat recovery pioneer.
Kansas City, USA	5MW → 40MW expansion (~35K GPUs)
New Jersey, USA	US expansion
Paris, France	European expansion

SUSTAINABILITY (good talking point)

- Custom servers use **20% less energy** than off-the-shelf
- Finland data center: **50+ GWh** of heat recovered for district heating
- PUE of **1.13** (world-class efficiency)

PART 4: WHAT THE INTERVIEWER MIGHT SAY

面试官可能说的话 - 提前熟悉这些句式，面试时就能听懂

Opening & Small Talk

What they say	中文意思	How to respond
"Hi Fei, how are you doing today?"	你今天怎么样?	"I'm doing great, thank you! How about you?"
"Thanks for joining / hopping on the call"	谢谢你来参加这个电话	"Thank you for having me!"
"Can you hear me okay?"	你能听到我吗?	"Yes, I can hear you clearly."
"Let me just share a bit about the role first"	让我先介绍一下这个职位	Just listen and nod. Take notes.
"Before we dive in..."	在我们开始之前...	Listen carefully for context.
"So tell me a little bit about yourself"	介绍一下你自己	Use your prepared self-intro!

Probing Questions (follow-ups)

What they say	中文意思	How to respond
"Can you elaborate on that?"	能详细说说吗?	Give more details with an example.
"Could you give me a specific example?"	能举个具体例子吗?	Use STAR format (Situation-Task-Action-Result).
"What was your role specifically?"	你具体负责什么?	Clarify YOUR contribution, not the team's.
"How did you handle that?"	你是怎么处理的?	Describe your actions step by step.
"What was the outcome?"	结果怎么样?	Give numbers if possible.
"What did you learn from that?"	你从中学到了什么?	Show growth and self-awareness.

Logistics & Process

What they say	中文意思	How to respond
"What's your notice period?"	你的离职通知期多长?	"I'm available immediately."
"Are you interviewing elsewhere?"	你在面试其他公司吗?	"Yes, I'm exploring a few opportunities, but Nebius is my top choice."
"What are your expectations in terms of compensation?"	你的薪资期望?	Use your prepared salary answer.
"Are you eligible to work in the Netherlands?"	你有荷兰工作许可吗?	Use your prepared visa answer.

"Do you have any questions for me?"	你有什么问题吗?	Use your prepared questions!

Closing Phrases

What they say	中文意思	How to respond
"I'll get back to you within a week"	一周内给你回复	"That sounds great. I look forward to hearing from you."
"The next step would be a technical interview"	下一步是技术面试	"Wonderful, I'm looking forward to it."
"We'll be in touch"	我们会联系你的	"Thank you so much for your time today, Milly."
"Is there anything else you'd like to add?"	还有什么要补充的吗?	"Just that I'm very excited about this opportunity. Thank you!"

PART 5: EMERGENCY PHRASES

听不懂时的救命句式 - 背熟这些，面试时不会尴尬冷场

WHEN YOU DON'T UNDERSTAND

Situation	What to say
Didn't hear clearly	**"Sorry, could you repeat that? The audio cut out for a moment."**
Heard but didn't understand	**"Could you rephrase that question? I want to make sure I answer it correctly."**
Need time to think	**"That's a great question. Let me think about that for a moment."**
Not sure about the question	**"Just to make sure I understand — are you asking about...?"**
Technical audio issue	**"I think there might be a connection issue. Could you say that one more time?"**
Lost in a long question	**"Sorry, I want to give you a good answer. Could you break that down for me?"**

KEY PRINCIPLE

It is **100% okay** to ask someone to repeat or rephrase. Native speakers do this all the time on Zoom calls. It shows you care about giving a good answer. **Never pretend you understood when you didn't.**

FILLER PHRASES (buy yourself time)

- "That's a great question..." *（好问题...）*
- "Let me think about the best way to explain this..." *（让我想想怎么说最好...）*
- "So, to give you some context..." *（给你一些背景...）*
- "I would say..." *（我会说...）*
- "From my experience..." *（根据我的经验...）*

TRANSITION PHRASES (sound natural)

- "Building on that..." *（在此基础上...）*
- "Another thing I'd like to mention is..." *（另外我想提到的是...）*
- "To give you a concrete example..." *（举个具体例子...）*
- "What I found most interesting was..." *（我觉得最有意思的是...）*
- "The key takeaway was..." *（关键收获是...）*

PART 6: PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

关键词发音指南 - 确保这些词说得清楚准确

COMPANY & PEOPLE NAMES

Word	Pronunciation	Notes
Nebius	**NEE-bee-us**	Like "nebula" + "-ius"
Arkady Volozh	**ar-KAH-dee VOH-lozh**	CEO's name
Yandex	**YAN-dex**	Former company name
NVIDIA	**en-VID-ee-uh**	GPU partner
Tavily	**TAV-ih-lee**	Recent acquisition

TECHNICAL TERMS

Word	Pronunciation
Airflow	**AIR-flow**
Databricks	**DAY-tuh-bricks**
Delta Lake	**DEL-tuh Lake**
PySpark	**PIE-spark**
Medallion Architecture	**meh-DAL-yun**
ETL	**E-T-L** (spell it out)
Kubernetes	**koo-ber-NET-eez**
Terraform	**TEHR-uh-form**
Schema	**SKEE-muh**
Pipeline	**PIPE-line**

PART 7: PRACTICAL TIPS & REMINDERS

SPEAKING STRATEGY

1. **Speak slowly.** You are not in a race. Slow = confident.
2. **Use short sentences.** One idea per sentence. Period. Next sentence.
3. **Pause between paragraphs.** Let the interviewer process what you said.
4. **Use structure words.** "First... Second... Third..." or "The situation was... My action was... The result was..."
5. **It's okay to be brief.** A clear 30-second answer beats a rambling 3-minute one.

BODY LANGUAGE ON ZOOM

- Look at the **camera**, not the screen (simulates eye contact).
- Sit up straight. Lean slightly forward = engaged.
- Nod when the interviewer speaks = "I'm listening."
- Smile naturally, especially at the start and end.
- Keep hands visible. Use small gestures when explaining.

THINGS TO AVOID

- **Don't badmouth** previous employers or China.
- **Don't say "I don't know"** — say "I haven't worked with that specifically, but I'm a fast learner and I've worked with similar tools like..."
- **Don't give one-word answers.** Always explain briefly.
- **Don't interrupt.** Wait for them to finish, then respond.
- **Don't discuss politics** (Yandex/Russia situation). Keep it factual and positive.

CLOSING STRONG

> **MEMORIZE THIS - END OF INTERVIEW**
>
> Thank you so much for your time today, Milly. I really enjoyed learning more about Nebius and the Data Engineer role. I am very excited about this opportunity, and I believe my experience with data pipelines, Spark, and Airflow would be a great fit for your team. I look forward to the next steps.

PART 8: REHEARSAL PLAN

排练计划

TONIGHT (Feb 10)

1. Read through this entire document once. *通读一遍*
2. Memorize the self-introduction (Part 1). Say it out loud 5 times.
3. Memorize the closing statement. Say it out loud 3 times.
4. Practice Q1-Q6 answers out loud. Record yourself and listen back.
5. Review company knowledge (Part 3). Quiz yourself on key numbers.
6. Practice emergency phrases (Part 5) until they feel natural.

TOMORROW MORNING (Feb 11)

1. Wake up early. Do a full rehearsal of self-intro + all Q&A.
2. Time your self-intro. Should be 60-90 seconds.
3. Review the cheat sheet one more time.
4. Test Zoom at 12:30 PM. Check audio, video, lighting.
5. Have water, notepad, and this cheat sheet ready.
6. Take 3 deep breaths before the call starts.

FINAL REMINDER

This is an HR screening, not a technical interview. They want to know: Are you a good communicator? Are you motivated? Do you fit the team? **Be warm, be clear, be enthusiastic.** You already have the technical skills — now show them you're a great person to work with.